

Three candidate predictors of clarification gain, with 95% bootstrap intervals

Qwen3-8B

Llama-3-70B

between-reading variance

undifferentiated answer variance

scalar confidence

−0.5 0.0 0.5 1.0

−0.5 0.0 0.5 1.0

Pearson r with realized gain, Set A only

Pearson r with realized gain, Set A only

Confidence was restricted to the 50–60% matching band by design and takes only two distinct values for Qwen3-8B; its weak correlation is a property of that restriction and is not evidence that confidence is uninformative in general.